

Donation Campaigns

User Manual — configuring and using the extension

Version 1.0.0-beta1

Contents

1. What it does
2. Install and enable
3. Configure the currency
4. Decide who may manage campaigns
5. Create a campaign
6. Manage an existing campaign
7. Record a donation
8. What your visitors see
9. Administrator oversight
10. Troubleshooting

1. What it does

Donation Campaigns attaches a **fundraising campaign to a topic** and shows a box above that topic's first post with the target amount, the amount collected, a progress bar and — optionally — the number of donations and the donors' names.

Two things are important before you start:

- **It records confirmed donations only.** A donation is money that has *already arrived* and that you enter by hand. The extension **does not process payments** and never talks to PayPal, a bank or any provider.
- **The “donate” button is just a link.** Each campaign points it at a web address you choose (a PayPal link, a bank-details page, another topic...). Whoever clicks it leaves the board; you confirm the money yourself afterwards.

2. Install and enable

1. Copy the extension to `ext/uflagmey/donationcampaigns/` on your board.
2. Go to **ACP** → **Customise** → **Extensions** → **Donation Campaigns** → **Enable**.

Or from the command line:

```
php bin/phpbbcli.php extension:enable uflagmey/donationcampaigns
php bin/phpbbcli.php cache:purge
```

Enabling creates the database tables, the settings, the permissions and the ACP menu. **Disabling** later hides everything but keeps your data; **purging** (uninstalling) deletes all campaigns and donations permanently.

3. Configure the currency

Go to **ACP** → **Extensions** → **Donation campaigns** → **Settings**.

Setting	Meaning
Currency code	Three letters, e.g. EUR , USD , GBP
Currency symbol	Shown next to every amount, e.g. €
Decimal places	2 for most currencies, 0 for yen, 3 for dinar
Donors listed	How many donor names the public box shows before summarising the rest

⚠ **Set the decimal places before recording your first donation.** Amounts are stored as whole numbers of the smallest unit (250.00 € is stored as 25000). Changing this setting later **re-reads every stored amount** rather than converting it, so a figure can suddenly appear ten or a hundred times too big or small. The extension warns you and asks for confirmation if data already exists.

4. Decide who may manage campaigns

The extension has **three permissions**. Administrators already have full access after installation, so you only need this section to let **other people** help.

Permission	Lets the holder...
Manage donation campaigns	Create, edit, enable/disable and delete <i>empty</i> campaigns
Manage confirmed donations	Add, edit and delete donations. ⚠ This exposes donor names, private donor identities and confirmed amounts — grant it only to people you trust with that personal data
(Administrator access)	Everything above on every forum, plus the ACP oversight and maintenance pages. Granted to the Full and Standard Administrator roles automatically

The two management permissions are **per forum** and **independent** — you can give someone one without the other.

Where to set them (the two management permissions):

1. **ACP** → **Permissions** tab.
2. Under **Forum based permissions**, choose **Forum moderators** (or *User / Group forum permissions*).
3. Select the **forum**, then the **user or group**.

4. Click **Advanced Permissions** and open the **Donation Campaigns** tab.
5. Set the permissions to **Yes** and click **Apply permissions**.

Note: granting either management permission makes that user a **moderator of that forum** — phpBB lists them as such. That is normal phpBB behaviour, not a side effect to worry about, but it is worth knowing.

5. Create a campaign

Campaigns are created **from the topic they belong to** — there is no topic number to type in.

1. Open the topic.
2. Click **Topic tools** (the wrench icon) → **Donation campaign**.
3. Fill in the form:

Field	Notes
Title	The heading of the public box
Description	Optional. BBCode, smilies and links are allowed
Target amount	For example <code>250.00</code> or <code>250,00</code> . Must be above zero
Donation link	Optional. A full <code>http://</code> or <code>https://</code> address
Link text	The words on the button, e.g. <i>Donate via PayPal</i> . Required if a link is set
Show donor names	Whether the public box may list donor names
Show donation count	Whether the box shows how many donations there are

4. Click **Submit**, then **Back to topic** — the box now appears above the first post.

One campaign per topic. The same **Donation campaign** menu entry later opens the **management page** for that campaign.

6. Manage an existing campaign

Open the topic → **Topic tools** → **Donation campaign**. The management page shows the campaign's status and its donations, with buttons for the actions you are allowed to perform:

- **Edit campaign** — change the title, target, link, etc.
- **Disable / Enable** — *Disable* hides the box from the topic but keeps every donation; *Enable* brings it back.
- **Delete** — only possible while the campaign has **no** donations. A campaign with donations must be disabled instead (an administrator can hard-delete it from the ACP if it really must go).

7. Record a donation

Only after the money has actually arrived and you have checked it.

1. Open the topic → **Topic tools** → **Donation campaign**.
2. Click **Add confirmed donation** (shown to holders of *Manage confirmed donations*).
3. Fill in the receipt:

Field	Notes
Amount	The amount that actually arrived, 50.00 or 50,00
Received on	The date the money arrived , not today's date
Donor	The name to show publicly. Leave empty to record it as <i>Anonymous</i>
Show donor publicly	Untick to count the donation but hide the donor's name

4. Click **Submit** — the campaign total is recalculated immediately.

Each donation in the list has **Edit** and **Delete** actions. A donation with its name hidden **still counts** towards the total and the donation count; only the name is withheld and shown as *Anonymous*.

Ask a donor before publishing their name. The extension cannot know whether you have their consent.

8. What your visitors see

On the topic, above the first post, the box shows the title, the optional description, a progress bar, the amount collected against the target, and — depending on the campaign's settings — the donation count and the list of donor names. Every confirmed donation is included with its amount; a private donation appears as *Anonymous* with its amount, never hidden.

9. Administrator oversight

The ACP (**ACP** → **Extensions** → **Donation campaigns**) is for **oversight and maintenance**, not day-to-day entry:

- **Campaigns** — a read-only list of every campaign on the board. Its row links open the campaign on its topic.
- **Donations** — a read-only list of a campaign's donations, with a link to manage them on the topic.
- **Recalculate total** — rebuilds a campaign's stored total from its donations (safe to run any time; useful after a restored backup).
- **Delete** — an administrator may delete even a **non-empty** campaign here (this cascades its donations); the confirmation names the campaign and its donation count.

Where actions are logged: work done from a topic is recorded in the **moderator log** (MCP → Forum logs), scoped to the forum and topic; work done in the ACP is recorded in the **administrator log** (ACP → Maintenance → Logs).

10. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Check
The box does not appear on the topic	Is the campaign enabled ? Purge the cache
The total looks wrong	Use Recalculate total in the ACP
Amounts are off by a factor of ten or a hundred	The decimal places setting was changed after data was recorded (see §3)
A donor's name shows when it should not	Check both switches: the campaign's <i>Show donor names</i> and that donation's <i>Show donor publicly</i>
The Donation campaign menu entry is missing on a topic	The user has neither management permission on that forum (see §4)

More detail is in the full documentation shipped with the extension: `README.md`, `docs/ADMIN_GUIDE.md` and `docs/PRIVACY.md`.